done with sincerity and strength. There was a visible decrease in the insurgency in Swat after the successful military operation in Swat in 2009. However, most of the TTP leadership could not be neutralised and annihilated. They had not given up the resolve to strike back. The follow-up stage was therefore crucial. The insurgents had the capacity and history to regroup and resume their activities afresh. Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb', the longest and most serious military operation against TTP and affiliates in North Waziristan, caused considerable damage to insurgents, but their terrorist activities in urban centres did not come to a halt, although the frequency decreased substantially.

To achieve sustainable success, the government of Pakistan should have devised a comprehensive and transparent counter-terrorism policy to bring about coherence among the intelligence agencies and LEAs. It could have given a direction to concerted efforts of all agencies and quarters. The civilian agencies and police could not get a clue due to directionlessness. The National Action Plan 2014 filled this gap of directionlessness to some extent. But its 20 points were a tall order, which needed to be prioritised and strategised in order to handle the same with the capacity of the agencies and departments for achieving the desired results. Additionally, a mechanism should be evolved to evaluate and monitor progress on the National Action Plan. The public was fed up of terrorism and violence and wanted the government to take action against the terrorists and extremists.

Furthermore, there was an urgent need to ensure amelioration under the socio-economic conditions of FATA as part of overall policy of emphasis on education, health and employment. FATA reforms and its merger in the KP province are necessary to bring the populace of this area to the mainstream so that they could enjoy the benefits available to other people of Pakistan. The majority of the people migrated from FATA to bigger cities such as Peshawar, Lahore, Karachi and Islamabad.

The measures taken after the harrowing terrorist attack on the Army Public School, Peshawar, on 16 December 2014 mitigated the severity of the situation, but total resolution remained a far cry. The terrorists were resilient, resourceful and quick to change their form and position to survive. The main leadership of TTP started operating from the border areas of Afghanistan. Their demands and form kept changing maliciously in order to keep their writ intact and to gradually expand it across the country. Moreover, the security situation and instability in